ENGLISH B2 · ANSWER KEY

Past ability and achievement

Solutions and feedback for the Past ability and achievement in English B2 exercise workbook.

THIS DOCUMENT

Answer key

Model answers and concise grammar explanations for every stage in the separate exercise workbook.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Correct one stage at a time. Explain the rule aloud before marking an answer as secure.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

01 · ANSWER KEY

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

General ability is the best match because a repeated or continuing ability in the past.

A2

Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.

Specific achievement is the best match because success in one difficult past situation.

A3

The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

Failed attempt is the best match because failure in a specific past attempt.

A4

a repeated or continuing ability in the past

The General ability pattern communicates a repeated or continuing ability in the past.

A5

success in one difficult past situation

The Specific achievement pattern communicates success in one difficult past situation.

A6

failure in a specific past attempt

The Failed attempt pattern communicates failure in a specific past attempt.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

General ability / a repeated or continuing ability in the past

The structure belongs to the General ability pattern. Its communicative purpose is a repeated or continuing ability in the past.

B2

Specific achievement / success in one difficult past situation

The structure belongs to the Specific achievement pattern. Its communicative purpose is success in one difficult past situation.

B3

Failed attempt / failure in a specific past attempt

The structure belongs to the Failed attempt pattern. Its communicative purpose is failure in a specific past attempt.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

General ability: could + base verb.

C2

Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.

Specific achievement: managed to / was able to + base.

C3

The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

Failed attempt: could not / was unable to + base.

C4

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

General ability: could + base verb.

C5

Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.

Specific achievement: managed to / was able to + base.

C6

The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

Failed attempt: could not / was unable to + base.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

could speak

General ability requires “could speak” in this model. could + base verb.

D2

managed to recover

Specific achievement requires “managed to recover” in this model. managed to / was able to + base.

D3

was unable to reproduce

Failed attempt requires “was unable to reproduce” in this model. could not / was unable to + base.

D4

could + base verb

General ability is built as could + base verb.

D5

managed to / was able to + base

Specific achievement is built as managed to / was able to + base.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

could + base verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended general ability effect.

E2

Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.

managed to / was able to + base. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended specific achievement effect.

E3

The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

could not / was unable to + base. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended failed attempt effect.

E4

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

could + base verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended general ability effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses could + base verb accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses managed to / was able to + base accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The technician was unable to reproduce the fault. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses could not / was unable to + base accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____